DSA ROADMAP: 4 LEVELS FROM ZERO TO JOB-READY

Follow this in order. Don't skip levels, don't rush level 1.

LEVEL 1: PICK A LANGUAGE

Before you touch DSA, pick ONE language and get comfortable with its syntax — loops, functions, arrays, basic OOP. Don't waste weeks comparing languages. Pick one, move on.

- **JavaScript** — best if you're also doing web dev, one language for everything 🔗 JS video: https://youtu.be/PkZNo7MFNFg?si=FJe0nEN5ootrv029
- **Python** — best if DSA/placements is your only goal, cleanest syntax, fastest to write 🔗 Python video: https://youtu.be/0K_eZGS5NsU?si=f-Gg1zBzzUgaODCR

LEVEL 2: LEARN DSA — CLASSIC PROBLEMS

This is where you actually learn arrays, strings, linked lists, trees, graphs, DP, etc. Follow a structured sheet — don't randomly solve problems off YouTube comments.

- **Striver's A2Z DSA Sheet** — structured, free, most recommended starting point 🔗 Striver sheet: https://takeuforward.org/dsa/strivers-a2z-sheet-learn-dsa-a-to-z
- **NeetCode 150/250** — pattern-based, great for understanding the "why" behind each problem 🔗 NeetCode sheet: https://neetcode.io/practice/practice/neetcode250

Tip: don't grind both. Pick Striver or NeetCode as your primary, use LeetCode 150 for revision after.

LEVEL 3: COMPETITIVE PROGRAMMING — THIS IS THE LEVEL THAT GETS YOU HIRED

Once you've built a base with classic problems, start doing contests. This builds speed and pattern recognition under time pressure — exactly what OAs test. If your goal is a good job, you don't need to go past this level.

- **LeetCode Contests** (Weekly + Biweekly) — timed, closest thing to real OA format 🔗 LeetCode contest: https://leetcode.com/contest/
- **Codeforces Contests** (Div 2 / Div 3) — harder, builds real CP thinking + a rating system that means something 🔗 Codeforces contest: https://codeforces.com/contests

This is the finish line for placements. A decent Codeforces rating or consistently solving 1-3 LeetCode contest problems puts you ahead of most applicants.

LEVEL 4: ICPC

Not required for placements. This is for people who want to take CP seriously at a competitive/academic level — team contest (3 people), regionals leading up to World Finals, needs strong fundamentals + speed + teamwork.

Full breakdown coming in a separate video.

Save this. Follow @Shrey.c0des for more.

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